

GUIDE 13

Hosting and deployment (Netlify)

Where the website runs, how updates go live, the settings it depends on, and how to undo a bad release.

Where the site lives

Hosting	Netlify, site <code>therobonest.netlify.app</code>
Code	GitHub repository, branch <code>main</code>
Deploys	Automatic. Every change pushed to <code>main</code> is built and published in about 3 to 5 minutes. Nothing to press.
Content updates	Need no deploy. Pages refresh from Odoo every 5 minutes by themselves.

Settings the site depends on

Netlify → Site configuration → Environment variables

Setting	Value
<code>ODOO_URL</code>	<code>https://robonest-private-limited.odoo.com</code> . Odoo's own address. Do not use <code>www.therobonest.com</code> : that now belongs to the website, and pointing the site at it breaks every page that reads Odoo.
<code>ODOO_DB</code>	<code>robonest-private-limited</code>
<code>ODOO_LOGIN</code>	The email of the Odoo user that owns the API key
<code>ODOO_API_KEY</code>	The key itself. Treat it like a password: it carries that user's full Odoo permissions.

After changing any setting: **Deploys** → **Trigger deploy** → **Clear cache and deploy site**.

Undo a bad release

Netlify → Deploys → pick an earlier deploy → Publish deploy

Netlify keeps every version. Going back is instant and needs no code change.

How the site talks to Odoo

- **Reads** (events, blog, team, schools, About text, social links): server side, every 5 minutes at most.
- **Writes**: only two, both through small Netlify functions. Website enquiries create CRM Leads; event sign-ups create Attendees.
- **Team photos** are fetched privately through the website (Odoo does not publish employee photos) and cached for a day on Netlify's network.

- **Rate limits:** Odoo Online refuses bursts of requests (HTTP 429). The website queues its Odoo calls, retries refused ones, and never saves a failed photo, so busy moments do not produce blank photos or lost enquiries.
- The API key exists only in Netlify's settings. It is never sent to visitors' browsers.

Built-in files for search engines and AI

/sitemap.xml	Every page, published post and event. Updates itself.
/robots.txt	Points search engines at the sitemap
/llms.txt	A plain summary of RoboNest for AI assistants (labs, facts, events, posts). Updates itself.

After launch, add `https://www.therobonest.com` in Google Search Console and submit the sitemap once.

Health check

1. The Events page lists your Odoo events.
2. Team photos on the About page are real photos, not initials.
3. A test enquiry marked "TEST" appears in CRM → Leads.

If all three fail together, check `ODOO_URL` and the API key first.